9. To advise the President on matters relating to the disqualifications of the members of Parliament.

10. To advise the governor on matters relating to the disqualifications of the members of state legislature.

11. To cancel polls in the event of rigging, booth capturing, violence and other irregularities.

12. To request the President or the governor for requisitioning the staff necessary for conducting elections.

13. To supervise the machinery of elections throughout the country to ensure free and fair elections.

14. To advise the President whether elections can be held in a state under president's rule in order to extend the period of emergency after one year.

15. To register political parties for the purpose of elections and grant them the status of national or state parties on the basis of their poll performance.

The Election Commission is assisted by deputy election commissioners. They are drawn from the civil service and appointed by the commission with tenure system. They are assisted, in turn, by the secretaries, joint secretaries, deputy secretaries and under secretaries posted in the secretariat of the commission.

At the state level, the Election Commission is assisted by the chief electoral officer, who is appointed by the chief election commissioner in consultation with the state government. Below this, at the district level, the collector acts as the district returning officer. He/she appoints a returning officer for every constituency in the district and presiding officer for every polling booth in the constituency.

VISION, MISSION AND PRINCIPLES

The vision, mission and guiding principles of the Election Commission are as follows[5]:

Vision The Election Commission of India strives to be an Institution of Excellence by enhancing active engagement, participation; and deepening and strengthening electoral democracy in India and globally.

Mission The Election Commission of India maintains independence, integrity and autonomy; ensures accessibility, inclusiveness, and ethical participation of stakeholders; and, adopts highest standards of professionalism for delivering free, fair, and transparent elections to strengthen the trust in electoral democracy and governance.

Guiding Principles The Commission has laid down for itself guiding principles of good governance:

1. To uphold the values enshrined in the Constitution viz, equality, equity, impartiality, independence; and rule of law in superintendence, direction and control over the electoral governance;

2. To conduct elections with highest standard of credibility, freeness, fairness, transparency, integrity, accountability, autonomy and professionalism;